

3.2.1. Tip 1: Make sure everyone uses your PTS

This first tip may seem obvious if you want to ensure you can get data from your system: make your PTS your one source of truth. Even though many teams use web-based project tracking, you'll still often see sticky notes on walls, email communication around issues, spreadsheets for tracking tasks and test cases, and other satellite systems that help you manage your work. All of these other systems generate noise and confusion and detract from your ability to get data that you can work with. If you've invested in a PTS, use it as the single source of truth for your development teams if you really want to mine data around how your team is functioning. Otherwise, the effort of collecting all the data from disparate sources becomes a tedious, manual, and time-consuming effort. It's best to spend your time analyzing data rather than collecting it.

Using your PTS is especially relevant when you have multiple teams that aren't colocated. Agile tends to work best with teams that are working together in the same place; it makes communication and collaboration much easier and allows everyone to contribute during planning, estimation, and retrospective meetings. But it's not always possible to have teams in the